



Friend



Enemy

Frenemy



Stay at home



Vacation

Staycation



A2 ENGLISH · INDUCTIVE GRAMMAR LESSON

The Present Tense Family

Simple Present · Present Continuous · Present Perfect · Present Perfect Continuous

Today we become grammar detectives —
and figure out, ourselves, how English talks about now.

Yesterday · Today · Tomorrow



YESTERDAY

Past



TODAY

Present



TOMORROW

Future

Type ONE thing you did yesterday, ONE thing that is true about you now, and ONE thing you will do tomorrow.

HANDOUT A

My IELTS Diary

I am sitting at my kitchen table right now, and I am finally writing this diary entry after a long day. My IELTS exam takes place next Friday, so I am a little nervous!

Let me tell you about my routine. I study English every day, usually for two hours in the evening. I always check new vocabulary before I sleep. My English class starts at 6 p.m. and finishes at 8 p.m. — it never changes, so I never miss the bus.

This month, I am staying at my aunt's house because my flat is being painted. It's strange, but I am adapting well. Unfortunately, my aunt's neighbour is always playing loud music at night, and it's really annoying!

Read for meaning first — don't worry about grammar yet.

HANDOUT A (CONTINUED)

My IELTS Diary

Here's some good news: I have lived in this city without my family, and I have learned so much English since I arrived. I have already taken two practice tests this month, and I have passed both of them! I have never given up, even when it's hard.

I have been studying English since 2019, and I have been practising speaking every day this week with my study partner. My eyes are red right now because I have been reading IELTS passages for the last three hours — but I think it's worth it.

One more fact for my science-loving friends: water boils at 100 degrees Celsius. I remembered that from my reading passage today! Funny what you learn while preparing for an exam.

Wish me luck for Friday! — Aisha

What did you understand?

- 1 Why is Aisha writing this diary?
- 2 How long has she been studying English?
- 3 What is she doing this month that is different from usual?
- 4 What is one problem she mentions?

Grammar Detectives: Color the Verbs



Routines, habits & facts

study · checks · starts · boils



Happening now / temporary

am sitting · am writing · is being painted



have / has + past participle

have lived · have learned · have passed



have / has been + -ing

have been studying · have been reading

Look Closely at the Diary Again

1

Yellow group (study, checks, starts, boils): do these actions happen once, or regularly / are they always true?

2

Green group (am sitting, am writing, is being painted): is this the exact moment of writing, or something more general?

3

Find the sentence with "always" in the green group. Does the speaker sound happy or annoyed about it?

4

Blue group (have lived, have passed, have never given up): do we know exactly WHEN these happened, or is the focus on the result now?

HANDOUT B

Look Closely at the Diary Again

5

Compare "I have lived here without my family " and "I have been studying English since 2019." What's the difference between for and since?

6

Red group: "my eyes are red because I have been reading for three hours." Finished action, or something with a visible result right now?

7

Find the sentences about Friday and the flat being painted. Which color group do they belong to — even though they describe the future or a temporary situation?

HANDOUT C

Write Your Own Rule

In your group, use your color examples to complete the table in your own words.

Tense (your color)	When do we use it?	How is it formed?
● Yellow examples	i. Regular, ii. General Truth, iii. Arranged Future	Subject – Verb (Base or Present) – Extension
● Green examples	i. Exact Moment, ii. Temporary, iii. Arranged Future	Subject – Helping Verb (am/is/are) – Verb (Present Participle) – Extension
● Blue examples	i. Result Focused	Subject – Helping Verb (have/has) – Verb (Past Participle) – Extension
● Red examples	i. Continuous Action from the Past	Subject – Helping Verb (have/has) been – Verb (Present Participle) – Extension

CLASS RULE CHART

Our Rule Chart: Present Tense Family

● Simple Present	base verb (+s/es for he/she/it/name)	habits & routines · facts & general truths · fixed schedules · fixed future plans
● Present Continuous	am / is / are + verb-ing	happening right now · temporary situations · annoying habits (+ always) · planned future arrangements
● Present Perfect	have / has + past participle	recently completed actions · life experiences · present relevance
● Present Perfect Continuous	have / has been + verb-ing	started in the past, continues now · recently stopped action with a visible result

HANDOUT D

Exercise 1 — Gap-Fill

Put the verb in brackets into the correct present tense.

1. Water _____ (boil) at 100°C.
2. Look! It _____ (rain) outside right now.
3. Aisha _____ (study) English for three years.
4. She _____ (study) English every day at 6 p.m.
5. My neighbour _____ always _____ (play) loud music!
6. I _____ just _____ (finish) my homework.
7. The train _____ (leave) at 9:15 tomorrow. (timetable)
8. He _____ (be) tired because he _____ (work) all night.
9. We _____ (meet) our teacher next Monday. (fixed plan)
10. They _____ (live) in Dhaka since 2015.

HANDOUT D

Exercise 2 — Sentence Transformation

Rewrite each sentence using the tense in brackets, keeping the meaning as close as possible.

1 Aisha started studying English in 2019. She still studies English now.

**Present Perfect
Continuous**

2 It is a fact: the sun rises in the east.

Simple Present

3 I am in the middle of reading this book.

Present Continuous

4 Aisha passed two practice tests this month, and this is important now.

Present Perfect

HANDOUT D

Exercise 3 — Error Correction

Find and correct the mistake in each sentence.

1 I am knowing the answer to this question.

2 She study English every day.

3 I have live here for five years.

4 My exam is take place next Friday.

5 He has been study for three hours.

ANSWER KEY

Exercise 1 — Answers

1. boils

2. is raining

3. has studied / has been studying

4. studies

5. is / playing

6. have / finished

7. leaves

8. is / has been working

9. are meeting

10. have lived

ANSWER KEY

Exercises 2 & 3 — Answers

Exercise 2 — Sample Answers

1. Aisha has been studying English since 2019.
2. The sun rises in the east.
3. I am reading this book.
4. Aisha has passed two practice tests this month.

Exercise 3 — Corrections

1. I know the answer to this question.
2. She studies English every day.
3. I have lived here for five years.
4. My exam takes place next Friday.
5. He has been studying for three hours.

know = stative verb, no continuous

3rd person -s

past participle needed

fixed schedule = simple present

-ing form needed after been

HOMEWORK

My Own Diary Entry

Write a short diary entry (100–120 words) about your life, similar to Aisha's.

It must include at least one example of each tense:

SP

Simple Present — a routine, fact, or fixed plan

PC

Present Continuous — something happening now or temporary

PP

Present Perfect — an experience or recent achievement, using for or since at least once

PPC

Present Perfect Continuous — something you've been doing for a while

Underline and label each tense (e.g., [SP], [PC], [PP], [PPC]) next to the sentence — just like we color-coded Aisha's diary in class.